

Ory Band

Staff / Principal Tech Lead - Distributed Systems, Data & AI Platforms

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VALUE PROP

Hands-on architect and tech lead who has shipped **large-scale, data-intensive backends** (up to **1B req/day**) and **production agentic systems**, and led teams through design, production, and observability. I turn messy, high-load systems into measurable, reliable platforms, and upskill the people around me while doing it.

CORE STRENGTHS

- **Distributed Systems & Scale:** 1B req/day pipelines, 100M+ daily task scheduling, HA/low-latency global services.
- **Agentic Systems & LLM Platforms:** Production agentic backends. LangGraph (incl. deep-agents pattern: planner + subagents + tool discovery), MCP servers/clients, multi-vendor LLM gateways with rate limiting and provider fallback.
- **Search, Retrieval & Evals:** Hybrid retrieval (semantic, lexical, cross-encoder rerank) over OpenSearch; deterministic eval pipelines that replaced expensive LLM-as-judge.
- **Technical Leadership:** End-to-end ownership; mentoring; cross-team initiatives across observability, cost, and velocity. Drove org-wide GenAI tooling adoption that multiplied team output.
- **Versatile Owner:** Self-onboard onto unfamiliar domains (crypto/Ethereum, EASM/security, GenAI/agents) and bring the team along via talks, brown-bags, mentoring.
- **Deep Debugging & Metrics:** Instrument-first; KPIs, dashboards, alerting, and incident processes across services.
- **Stack:** Python, Go, Clojure, Bash, JS/TS (also C/C++, Java, Solidity).
Cloud/Data: AWS, GCP, Azure, Nebius; BigQuery, BigTable, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Elasticsearch/OpenSearch; Kafka/RabbitMQ; K8s, Terraform, Docker; Prometheus, DataDog, OpenTracing, LangSmith.

SELECTED IMPACT

- **60% retrieval quality lift** on Monday's agentic search RAG platform, launched as the primary retrieval inside Monday's flagship AI agent and reaching the majority of paying customers.
 - **Eval iteration time from days to minutes, per-run cost from ~\$1,500 to effectively zero** by replacing LLM-judged labeling with deterministic template-derived ground truth. Adopted as the AI Group's baseline.
 - **Owned a production agentic backend at 200K req/min** (multimodal CoT) on a startup founding-engineer team.
 - **1B req/day streaming pipeline** (Golang, GCP) feeding BigQuery, ElasticSearch, Prometheus.
 - **100M+ tasks/day scheduler** for customer-facing attack vector scans against S&P 500 and Fortune 100 enterprises. **Still in production today.**
 - Designed and shipped the **Ethereum smart contract for one of the largest crypto ICOs of its era** (Kin / Kik); central technical role.
 - Open-sourced a [high-throughput Go library](#) for concurrent streaming inserts into BigQuery (~130 stars, **cited by Google BigQuery core engineers**).
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EXPERIENCE

2025 - Present | Monday.com | Senior Tech Lead / Backend Architect | AI Platform Group

- Tech lead and architect of Monday's **agentic search RAG platform**. Stateless LangGraph + MCP server with hybrid retrieval (semantic, lexical, cross-encoder rerank) over OpenSearch, query decomposition into parallel multi-tool calls with retry/fallback, LangSmith observability. Took it from internal tool to **primary retrieval inside Monday's flagship AI agent, reaching the majority of paying customers. 60% retrieval quality improvement.**
- Architected and owned the AI Group's **search evaluation framework**. Synthetic-corpus pipeline at production scale (thousands of boards, hundreds of thousands of items mirroring real-world account structure) with a balanced benchmark of thousands of queries. Replaced LLM-judged labeling with deterministic template-derived ground truth: **iteration time from days to minutes, per-run cost from ~\$1,500 to effectively zero.** Adopted as the AI Group's baseline for retrieval, reranker, and embedding-model decisions.
- Built features in Monday's company-wide **LLM access SDK**. Load-balances across vendors (OpenAI, Anthropic, Google) and providers (vendor-direct, AWS, Azure, GCP, Nebius), with multi-tenant priority rate limiting and provider fallback.

- Contributed shared plugins and skills to the AI Group's Claude Code platform. **Open-sourced** a [Claude Code tool that auto-approves compound shell commands](#), pushing agent autonomy further without weakening safety.

2025 | Alma (Stealth) | Senior Tech Lead / Backend Architect

- Owned a production multimodal agentic backend (CoT reasoning) for a creative content product. Peak 200K req/min.
- Designed and built an **MCP-based natural-language interface** that became the team's primary way of operating the product. Every role, creative through ops, drove the system in plain English at the level of intent rather than clicking through interfaces step by step. Goal was an order-of-magnitude lift in per-person capability and making AI-native operation the default working mode across the company.

2020 - 2025 | CyCognito | Hands-on Tech Lead, Backend

External Attack Surface Management (EASM) for S&P 500 and Fortune 100 enterprises. Lead engineer in a ~12-person backend group, fully hands-on.

- **100M+ tasks/day scheduler** for **customer-facing attack vector scans** against global enterprise infrastructure. High throughput and low latency, with load distribution that avoids disrupting the customer's own infra mid-scan. Cost-aware and observable. **Still in production today** as the backbone of the company's attack surface scheduling.
- **Discovery and exposure mapping system**, inherited in alpha state after the original team left the company. Onboarded solo and brought it to production. The system reconstructs a target enterprise's full corporate tree many layers deep (often surfacing subsidiaries the parent didn't know it owned) and attributes every internet-facing asset (domains, certificates, websites, personnel, financial filings) to its rightful owner. Behaves like an attacker doing reconnaissance, and feeds the scheduler above with a continuous stream of new entry points.
- **KPI extraction and escalation framework**: pulled metrics and textual signals from multiple internal systems and turned them into the product- and leadership-level numbers the company actually steered by.
- Mentored across the whole group, not just engineers (data, QA/testing, finance, and others); led adoption of AI tooling and modern dev practices. **2x team velocity** after migration to AI-first IDEs (Claude Code, Cursor).

2017 - 2020 | Kik | Tech Lead, Backend (Kin / Crypto pivot)

- Designed and implemented the **Ethereum smart contract for the Kin ICO**, one of the largest crypto ICOs of its era. Central technical role on the smart contract side (token, multisig, vesting, testing).
- Deployed and maintained multiple blockchain networks (production, research, test) on cloud infra.

- Internal go-to for blockchain consensus, incentives, and spam mitigation.

2014 - 2017 | Rounds (acquired by Kik in 2017) | Backend Engineer

- Owned event streaming and ETL pipeline (Golang, GCP). **~1B req/day, 700K req/min.**
- Implemented group video backends; benchmarked and optimized infra costs at scale.
- Built distributed monitoring stack with Prometheus + Influx/Telegraf.

2006 - 2011 | Earlier Roles

Backend and full-stack across Israeli military intelligence R&D (VoIP and messaging protocols), set-top-box media systems (PeerTV), and full-stack web video (Venvid: frame-accurate web editor plus Android via PhoneGap; Python/Django/Flask).

EDUCATION

B.Sc. Mathematics & Computer Science - Ben-Gurion University (2011-2014)

- Graduate-level ML foundations.
 - **MapReduce via browsers/mobile** proof-of-concept: 100K tasks dispatched to WebWorkers/WebSockets; Golang master. [Repo](#)
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COMMUNITY & OPEN-SOURCE

- **Public Knowledge Workshop (2009-2019):** Open-source government data scrapers and search tools (e.g., semantic analysis of Israeli State Comptroller reports).
 - Blog/Medium writer; frequent internal talks and brown-bags.
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INTERESTS

Guitar & piano, sci-fi 🤖, city cycling, experimenting with new tech.